PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #55 · PTSD

“My future holds only more pain. I will never feel safe or whole again.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When pain has lasted, the mind protects itself by expecting more of the same. “If I do not hope, I cannot be disappointed.” That can feel like realism. It is a closed future: only more pain, never safe, never whole. You do not have to pretend the past was small. You also do not have to sign away every year ahead. A counselor can help you hold both the wound and a future that is not only the wound. A counselor can help you work with this at a pace that is safe. You do not have to do it alone, or all at once. If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988 in the United States, or tell someone near you right away.

What Scripture teaches

The Lord’s mercies are new every morning. Weeping may stay the night, and joy comes in the morning. God heals the brokenhearted. Nothing in the present or the future can separate His people from His love. When you pass through deep waters, He is with you, and the waters do not get the last word. These verses do not say the pain was good, or that you must feel whole today. They say “only more pain” is a forecast you do not have to believe.

> *“Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!”* (Lamentations 3:22–23).

Also see

> “For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning” (Psalm 30:5).

> “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds” (Psalm 147:3).

> “For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord” (Romans 8:38–39).

> “When you pass through the waters, I will be with you; and when you go through the rivers, they will not overwhelm you. When you walk through the fire, you will not be scorched; the flames will not set you ablaze” (Isaiah 43:2).

Common self-statements

- The rest of my life will feel like this.
- Hoping is a trick.
- I will never feel safe or whole, so I should stop wanting that.
- Good things are for people who were not hurt.
- If God loved me, the future would already look different.
- I should not make plans.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Writing every future year from today’s pain.
- Overgeneralization: Turning a long wound into “only pain from now on.”
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling hopeless and calling that a fact about the future.
- Discounting the positive: Refusing any mercy, relationship, or ease that does not fit the forecast.

Challenging questions

- What do I actually know about next year, and what am I guessing?
- Has any day been even slightly different from the worst day?
- Would I tell a friend their whole future is only pain?
- What is one small plan that does not require me to feel whole first?
- What does “mercies new every morning” allow me to expect besides a perfect life?
- Who can help me look at the future without being flooded?

Truth summary

> My future is not only more pain. God is with me, His mercy is new, and wholeness can grow even while I still hurt.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

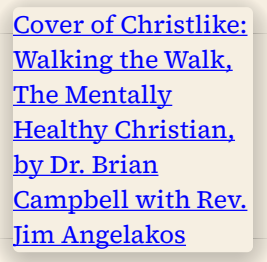
- Hopeless
- Sorrow
- Depression, Symptoms of
- Peace
- Suffering

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Depression
- Suffering
- Grief

What does a mentally healthy Christian look like?



Cover of Christlike: Walking the Walk, The Mentally Healthy Christian, by Dr. Brian Campbell with Rev. Jim Angelakos

From *Christlike: Walking the Walk* by Dr. Brian Campbell. A portrait, verse by verse, of how a mentally healthy Christian thinks, feels, and lives.

Read excerpts from “The Mentally Healthy Christian” (with every Scripture written out)

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
The future is not only the pain behind you. Christ is a living hope.

Forever — Kari Jobe
Resurrection says pain does not own the last chapter.

Hymn of Heaven — Phil Wickham
There is a future with God that this hurt does not get to cancel.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
Mercies are new in the morning, even when today still hurts.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, what is one step I could take today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My future holds only more pain. I will never feel safe or whole again."

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My future holds only more pain. I will never feel safe or whole again." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I actually know about next year, and what am I guessing?
- ☐ Has any day been even slightly different from the worst day?
- ☐ Would I tell a friend their whole future is only pain?
- ☐ What is one small plan that does not require me to feel whole first?
- ☐ What does "mercies new every morning" allow me to expect besides a perfect life?
- ☐ Who can help me look at the future without being flooded?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My future is not only more pain. God is with me, His mercy is new, and wholeness can grow even while I still hurt.
- ☐ I do not know the whole future, and pain does not get to write it.
- ☐ God's mercy is new this morning.
- ☐ I can hurt today and still not be doomed to only hurt.
- ☐ Nothing in the future can separate me from God's love.
- ☐ I can take one day, with a counselor's help, without settling every year.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Lamentations 3:22–23
  "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!"
- ☐ Psalm 30:5
  "For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning."
- ☐ Psalm 147:3
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When the future felt like only pain: Each day, write down one moment when hope felt like a trick. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Lamentations 3:22–23 becomes: "Sarah can write: "His mercies are new this morning. Today is not the whole future.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio or the Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] One small plan. Schedule one ordinary good thing this week. You do not have to feel whole to keep it.
- [ ] Write "I don't know yet" next to a fear about the future. Leave it unknown instead of tragic.
- [ ] Tell your counselor that the future feels like only pain. Let them help you go slowly.
- [ ] If this includes wanting to die, call or text 988, or tell someone near you today. You do not have to carry a closed future alone.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My future holds only more pain. I will never feel safe or whole again.": _____ %

My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment the future was not only pain
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My future holds only more pain. I will never feel safe or whole again~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have decided the future is only pain. Your mercies are new this morning. Stay with me, open a little room in the days ahead, and give me people who will walk there with me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.